Microsoft

Maturity Model for Microsoft 365 Practitioners

September 2026

Revisiting the Governance, Risk, and Compliance Competency



✨ **Guest star** ✨ Nikki Chapple

Current Core Team

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Emeriti

Emily Mancini, Left Uncharted | @eemancini

Initiative started by Sadie [Van Buren] Gilronan as the SharePoint Maturity Model in 2010

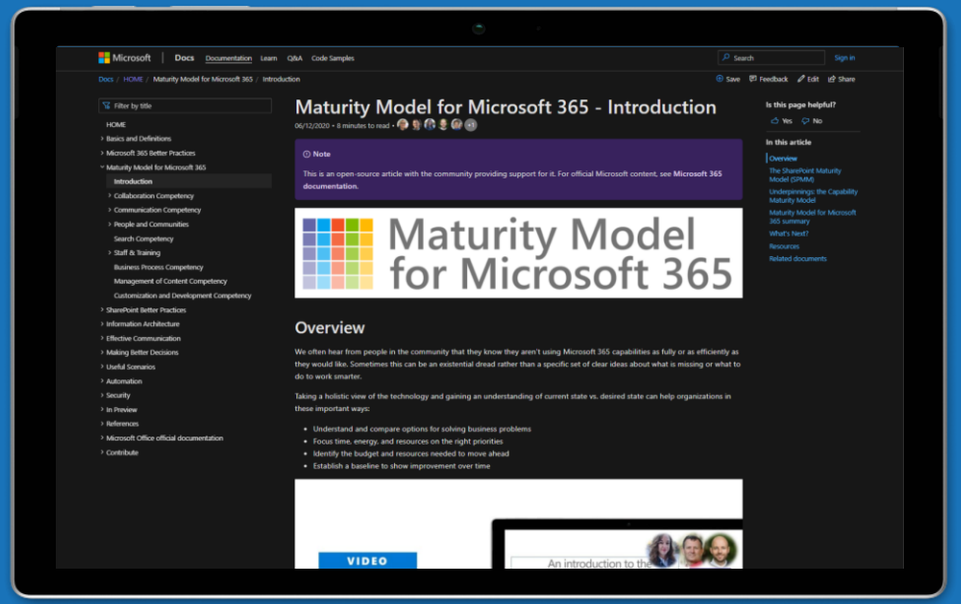
Agenda

Practitioner & Maturity Model overview

- Artifacts and Updates
- Purpose

Contribute

The main event



https://symp.info/MM4M365



Reminders

Join us every month!

Download the recurring calendar series

https://aka.ms/mm4m365/invite

Currently broken – working on it!

Global Microsoft 365 & Power Platform Meetup

https://www.meetup.com/global-microsoft-365-dev-meetup/events/

MM4M365 - Purpose and articles

PURPOSE

- Improve organization through use of technology
- Benchmark company and department
- Select appropriate approach
- Develop an organizational business and technical roadmap based on:
  - What's possible
  - What's desired
  - Organization's culture and drivers
- Lead and support strategic planning, with senior management
- Align implementation needs and objectives
- Discuss use of the platform with IT – not just technology
- Socialization tool

https://symp.info/MM4M365

Artifacts

Published competencies

- AI & Cognitive Business ✨
- Business Process ✨
- Collaboration ✨
- Communication ✨
- Customization & Development ✨
- Employee Experience ✨
- Governance, Risk & Compliance ✨
- Infrastructure ✨
- Management of Content ✨
- People & Communities
- Search ✨
- Security
- Staff & Training

✨ = Key actions highlighted

How to elevate...

- Collaboration
- Communication
- People & Communities
- Staff & Training
- Governance, Risk and Compliance
- Security

Practical Scenarios

- Microsoft 365 Service Change Management
- Servicing Microsoft 365 Apps
- Servicing Health Management
- Enhancing Brand Management
- Knowledge Management

Supporting articles

- Search
- Communication

Tools

- Running a MM4M365 workshop
- Practitioner meeting recordings

In progress competencies

- Data & Analytics

Artefacts, structure, and scope

The Maturity Model

- Competencies
- Principles
- How to elevate…
- Practical scenarios

Competencies

- Overview etc.
- Evolution
  - Characteristics grouped by sub-competency
  - Level 100-500
- Scenarios, Costs & Benefit, Conclusion
- Microsoft 365 Toolsets
- Resources & contributors

Sub-competencies

- Group characteristics into common categories
- Some consistency across competencies

Characteristics

- Grouped by Level
- Grouped by sub-competency
  - Sparkled
  - Unsparkled

Business capability (Competency)

Business activities (Scenarios)

Technologies (Microsoft 365 Toolsets)

Business Functions

Markets

MM4M365 provides benchmarks to measure your organization

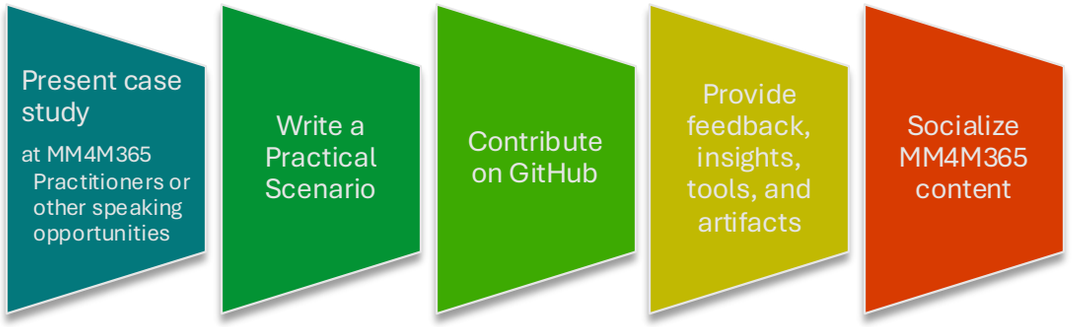
Maturity Level	Description/characteristics	Intent
Level 500 Optimizing	Optimal, systematic, statistical, improvement-focus, automated, assured, proactive	“We want to ensure all the key processes are always effective and resilient, while designing the same into anything new we do”
Level 400 Predictable	Productive, interactive, responsive, enhanced, effective, adaptable, quality	“Let’s make things even better by measuring, analyzing and taking actions to improve based on that“
Level 300 Defined	Documented, policy-driven, planned, controlled, stable	“We have defined our processes, policies and procedures, everyone seems to be doing the right thing; let’s keep doing that”
Level 200 Managed	Routine, legacy, fire-fighting, variable, personally managed	“We should ensure everyone knows what they should be doing”
Level 100 Initial	Ad hoc, reactive, uncontrolled, chaotic, unstable, not designed	“Let’s keep putting the fires out and keep the lights on!”

Overview

Practitioners for Maturity Model for Microsoft 365

Get Involved

https://symp.info/SiCCommunityContentGuide



Run a MM4M365 workshop

- https://symp.info/MM4M365Workshop

Purpose

Safe space to:

- Share & test your thoughts
- Guide the process and content
- Decide how to promote your use of the Maturity Model
- Hone your pitch

Discussion-based monthly meeting

- Understand the competencies & measuring maturity
- Awareness of new assets
- Feedback on the maturity model
- Share anecdotes and success stories
- Map technology, maturity level & competencies
- Run workshops

Upcoming topics in 2026

January 20	February 17	March 17	April 21	May 19	June 16
Maturity Model for Microsoft 365 Agent	MM4M365 AMA	Security Competency	Revisiting the Staff and Training Competency	Frontier Firm: Maturity Model Perspective	Revisit the People and Communities Competency
⭐ Simon Doy ⭐	⭐ Everyone ⭐	⭐ Mats Warnolf ⭐ ⭐ Clement Betacorne ⭐	⭐ Emily Mancini ⭐	⭐ Merethe Stave ⭐	⭐ Tracy van der Schyff ⭐

July 21	August 18	September 15	October 20	November 17	December 15
Summer break	*Summer break*	Revisiting the Governance, Risk, and Compliance Competency	Modern Compliance in Microsoft 365: A Maturity Model Perspective	AI at Work: MM4M365	*Winter break*
None	None	⭐ Nikki Chapple ⭐	⭐ Joanne Klein ⭐	⭐ Core Team ⭐	None

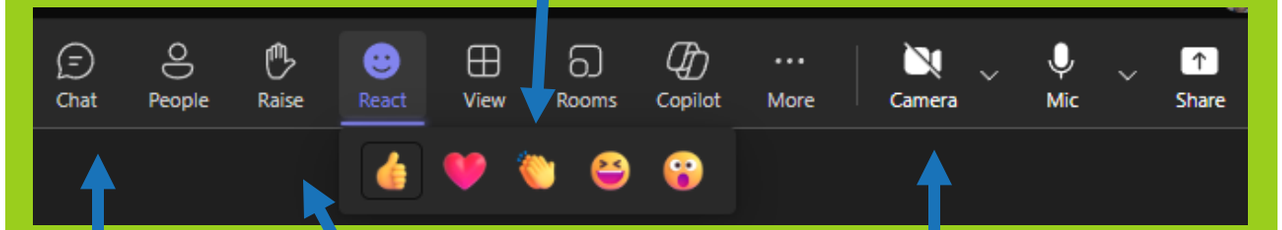
The Main Event

Revisiting the Governance, Risk, and Compliance Competency

PROTOCOL

Visually emote and support
Share reactions while others are speaking

Come off mute and share your thoughts



Ask questions, offer insights, talk to each other

Raise your hand to say your piece (and put it down again!)

Share your camera (don’t be shy)

Agenda

CONTEXT

WHAT CHANGED?

1

Why the 2021 competency no longer maps cleanly to the 2026 governance environment.

BOUNDARY

WHAT BELONGS IN GRC?

2

Clarify what GRC owns and what belongs in the specialist competencies.

RECOMMENDATION

WHAT SHOULD CHANGE?

3

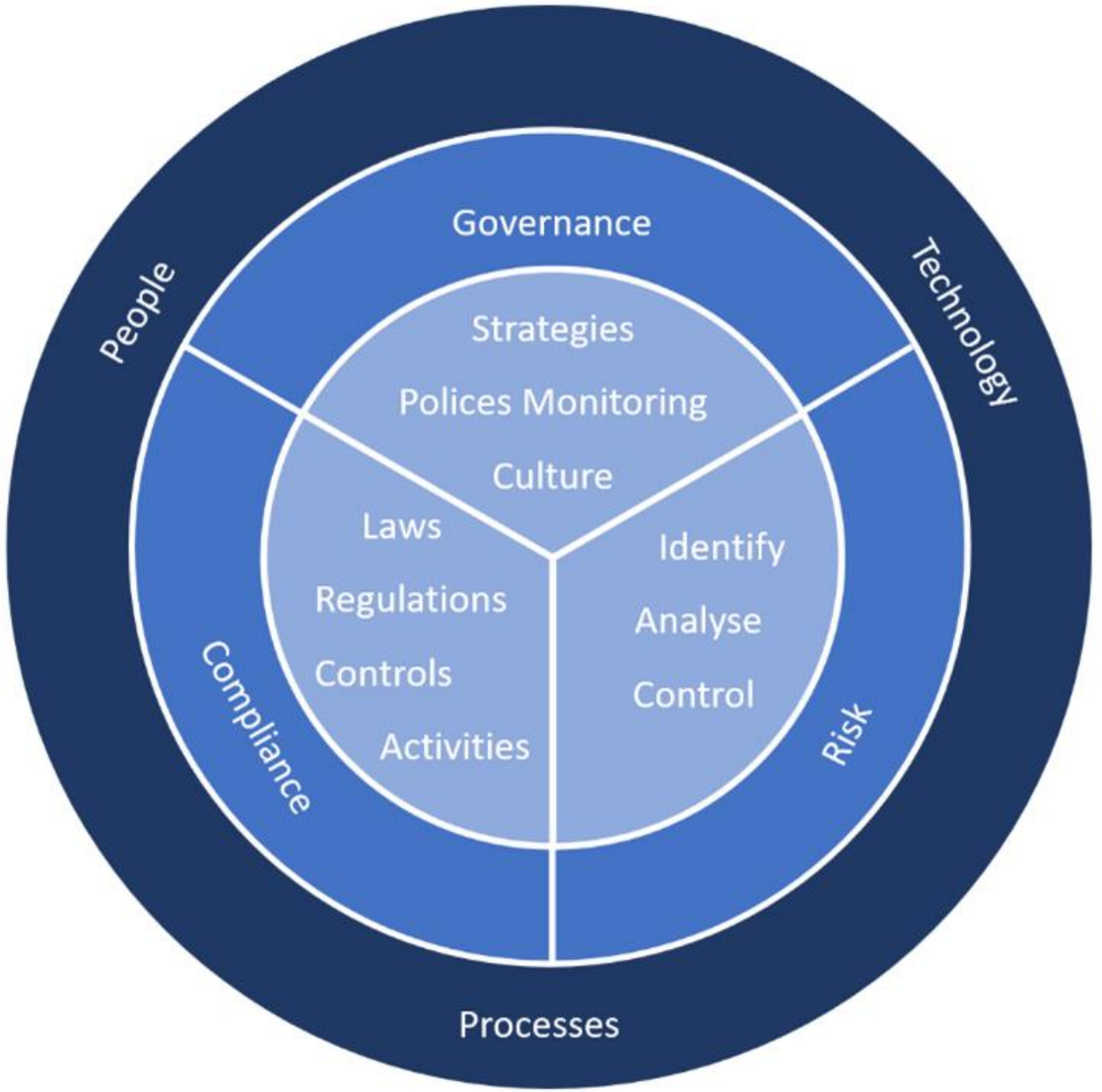
Test the four-capability model and the revised 100–500 maturity story.

The question is not whether GRC matters. It is what GRC should own.

What We Were Trying to Govern in 2021

Governance is not technology alone.

Effective governance requires people, process and technology working together.



The Working World in 2021

Hybrid work became the organising principle for the digital workplace

Hybrid work

Work moved across home, office and mobile environments.

Digital-first collaboration

Teams, SharePoint and OneDrive became central to everyday work.

Employee experience

Wellbeing, fatigue, culture and adoption moved up the agenda.

2021 governance question

How do we govern people using Microsoft 365?

2021 → 2026: The Governance Environment Changed

2021		2026
Humans were dominant actors	→	People, applications, AI and agents participate
Collaboration & productivity	→	AI and automation embedded in work
Tenant and content controls	→	Decisions, delegation and outcomes
Predefined application logic	→	Autonomous and agentic systems
Periodic governance	→	Continuous governance

The challenge is no longer only how we govern people using Microsoft 365.
It is how we govern people, information, AI, agents and decisions.

Why the GRC Competency Must Evolve

The governance questions have expanded beyond people, policies and platform controls

01	WHO CAN ACT?	People, applications, AI and agents
02	WHAT DO THEY DEPEND ON?	Trusted information
03	HOW DO WE KNOW?	Evidence and assurance
04	HOW DO WE KEEP UP?	Continuous learning and adaptation

From static control checklists to dynamic governance of decisions, actions, outcomes and change

Where Does the Work Belong?

QUESTION	GRC	SPECIALIST
Why is this needed?	OWNS	INFORMS
What risk or obligation drives it?	OWNS	INFORMS
Who owns decisions, risk and exceptions?	OWNS	ACCEPTS ROLE
What outcome should the control achieve?	OWNS	DESIGNS TO OUTCOME
How is it implemented and operated?	SETS GUARDRAILS	OWNS
What evidence is produced?	DEFINES NEED	PROVIDES
Is it effective?	CHALLENGES / ASSURES	DEMONSTRATES

GRC sets the requirement → Specialists operate the control → Evidence returns to GRC

The Proposed Modern GRC Competency

Four connected capabilities form a continuous governance system

1. WHO?

Governance & Accountability

Ownership & decision rights

2. WHAT COULD GO WRONG?

Risk Management

Identification & treatment

3. WHAT MUST WE DO?

Obligations, Policy & Compliance

Requirements & controls

4. HOW DO WE KNOW?

Evidence & Assurance

Monitoring & assurance

Evidence and insight drive adaptation

AI and agents cut across all four. They are not a fifth GRC domain.

How Modern GRC Operates

Five principles shape every capability and maturity level



One requirement. Many competencies. One GRC outcome.

Example: protect sensitive information shared externally

GOVERNANCE REQUIREMENT

GRC DEFINES THE OUTCOME

Obligation • risk • accountability • control objective • exceptions • evidence

Security

Identity • access • protection • detection • response

Management of Content

Classification • lifecycle • retention • records

Collaboration

External sharing • guests • workspaces • operating practices

AI & Cognitive Business

AI use • grounding • agents • human oversight

Other competencies may contribute depending on the scenario:

Staff & Training • Infrastructure • Search • Business Process etc

GRC owns the governance connection. Specialist competencies implement and operate the controls.

Agents are the stress test for modern GRC

WHO?

- Who owns the agent?
- Who delegates authority?
- Who approves exceptions?

RISK?

- What can it access, decide, trigger or change?
- What residual risk remains?

MUST DO?

- What obligations and guardrails apply?

HOW DO WE KNOW?

- Can we prove decisions, actions and outcomes?

Agents do not create a new governance model.
They simply expose the need for the four governance capabilities we have just discussed.

Maturity Progression (100 - 500)

Maturity describes how governance operates, Not how many technologies are deployed.

100
Initial

We react

Informal and issue-driven

200
Managed

We actively manage

Ownership and repeatability emerge

300
Defined

We operate consistently

Documented and standardised

400
Predictable

We know it works

Measured and evidenced

500
Optimising

We learn and adapt

Insight drives improvement

Maturity describes how governance operates, not how many technologies are deployed.

Applying Maturity Across the Four GRC Capabilities

Illustrative maturity profile: assess each capability independently, then set a risk-based target



READ THE PROFILE

1. **Assess each capability**
   Use the same 100–500 scale, but score each capability independently.
2. **Set the target**
   Choose a target based on risk, obligations and business priorities.
3. **Find the gaps**
   Look for weak capabilities and weak connections between them.
4. **Prioritise improvement**
   Focus investment where it strengthens the intended governance outcome.

Illustrative values only.

The goal is not equal scores. It is sufficient alignment to support the intended governance outcome.

What should change in the written competency?

A root-and-branch edit

KEEP

- GRC as organisational capability
- 100–500 maturity
- Risk-based governance
- Accountability
- Obligations and compliance
- Evidence and assurance

REDUCE

- Detailed control instructions
- Product-specific implementation
- Duplicate Security, Content and AI guidance
- Technology deployment as a maturity proxy

ELEVATE

- Delegated authority
- Agent accountability
- Risk appetite
- Exceptions
- Evidence of effectiveness
- Continuous adaptation

MOVE TO SPECIALIST COMPETENCIESS

- Identity implementation
- Information protection
- Retention configuration
- AI and agent controls
- Search and grounding
- Security operations

Future state
GRC defines the Why, What, Who and How Do We Know.
Specialist competencies define the How.

My recommendation to the MM4M365 community

1. Retain GRC as one cross-cutting competency.
2. Rebuild it around four capabilities and the 100–500 progression.
3. Move operational “how-to” guidance into specialist competencies.
4. Use GRC to connect requirements, accountability, risk, control objectives, evidence and assurance.

GRC becomes the governance architecture connecting specialist competencies.

From governing Microsoft 365 to governing the digital ecosystem

GRC provides the governance architecture that connects decisions, risk, requirements and evidence across the digital ecosystem.



Thank you

Next MM4M365 monthly call

October 20 – 10 ET / 7 PT

Third Tuesday of every month: https://aka.ms/mm4m365/invite

Stay in touch

- Articles: https://symp.info/MM4M365
- Newsletter: Sign up
- LinkedIn group: Maturity Model for Microsoft 365 Community
- YouTube: http://mmvideos.m365.ms/
- Slide decks: https://symp.info/MM4M365Slides
- Twitter/X: @M365Maturity | @M365CommDocs | #MM4M365
- BlueSky: @mm4m365.org

Take the Maturity Model Self-Assessment

- Fill out the Maturity Model Survey: https://symp.info/MM4M365Survey






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